

7.9 Existing superpowers face ongoing economic restructuring, which challenges their power.	a. Economic problems (debt, unemployment, economic restructuring, social costs) represent an ongoing challenge to superpowers (🌐 USA and EU).
	b. The economic costs of maintaining global military power (naval, nuclear, air power, intelligence services) and space exploration are questioned in some existing superpowers.
	c. The future balance of global power in 2030 and 2050 is uncertain and there are a range of possible outcomes (continued USA dominance, bi-polar and multi-polar structures). (F: uncertainty over future power structures) (6)

Guidance for integrating geographical skills for Topic 7

The following skills provide suggested opportunities for integrating the full range of skills outlined in the geographical skills appendix (*Appendix 1*). These skills are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these skills across any suitable topic area throughout their course of study.

- (1) Constructing power indexes using complex data sets, including ranking and scaling.
- (2) Mapping past, present and future sphere of influence and alliances using world maps.
- (3) Using graphs of world trade growth using linear and logarithmic scales.
- (4) Mapping emissions and resource consumption using proportional symbols.
- (5) Plotting the changing location of the world's economic centre of gravity on world maps.
- (6) Analysing future Gross Domestic Product (GDP) using data from different sources.